
AELITA COMMUNITY · ENTREPRENEURS GROUP

READING PROGRAMME

14 books · Starting September 2026

The list has been updated — as the club evolved, it moved from pure economics to a wider range of subjects: the psychology of family and power, the anthropology of conflict and strategy, the philosophy of language and thought. Each book here explains, in its own way, why the decisions we call strategic don't actually run up against the market or resources, but against whether we have words for what doesn't exist yet.

14 books — from the psychoanalysis of family to Buddhist philosophy — read to build a working picture of what governs our decisions but usually goes unnoticed.

BOOK 1 OF 14

“Games People Play”

Eric Berne

A classic of transactional analysis — the shared vocabulary for the rest of the list: which ‘games’ we play with each other without noticing, and what hidden payoff lies inside them.

BOOK 2 OF 14

“How to Read a Book”

Mortimer Adler

Not about speed-reading, but about reading in a way that actually changes how you think, rather than just adding another title to a list.

BOOK 3 OF 14

“The Family and Individual Development”

Donald Woods Winnicott

How early experience with the mother shapes basic trust and the capacity to be with others without losing yourself — the foundation everything else in relationships and in work rests on.

BOOK 4 OF 14

“The Father”

Luigi Zoja

Who the Father is in psychology and culture, and how his presence or absence shapes the willingness to take responsibility — not only in the family, but in a project, in a team.

BOOK 5 OF 14

“Centuries of Childhood: A Social History of Family Life”

Philippe Ariès

A classic historical study: the very idea of ‘childhood’ hasn't always existed — it was invented at a specific point in history. Shows that even our most ‘natural’ categories are, in fact, constructed.

BOOK 6 OF 14

“The Russian Family, 11th–19th Centuries”

Vasily Leshchenko

Family as an economic institution, on Russian material — how economic and power roles inside the family shifted over the centuries.

BOOK 7 OF 14

“Morphology of the Folktale”

Vladimir Propp

An exercise in formal analysis: behind the endless variety of plots, Propp found a limited set of stable functions and the structure of the hero's journey — a method that reaches far beyond folklore.

BOOK 8 OF 14

“On Aggression”

Konrad Lorenz

A look at nature: if aggression and territoriality are biologically built into us, what do we do with that in relationships and in business, where competition and cooperation are intertwined.

BOOK 9 OF 14

“Strategy: The Logic of War and Peace”

Edward Luttwak

The paradoxical logic of strategy: what works in linear logic often doesn't work in strategic logic — the straight road to a goal isn't always the shortest one.

BOOK 10 OF 14

“The Nature of the Firm”

Ronald Coase

The classic paper that started the entire theory of transaction costs — why firms exist at all, if the market already allocates resources efficiently.

BOOK 11 OF 14

Lectures and materials on money and the entrepreneur

Pyotr Shchedrovitsky

On the entrepreneur not as a business owner, but as a figure who connects resources and opportunities where no one else saw the connection.

BOOK 12 OF 14

“Thinking and Observation. Introduction to the Study of Buddhist Philosophy”

Alexander Piatigorsky

An examination of what it even means to observe your own thinking — and how Buddhist philosophy systematizes that capacity.

BOOK 13 OF 14

“What Is Political Philosophy”

Alexander Piatigorsky

On the language we use to describe power — and on the fact that the very ability to formulate political thought is a separate skill, not reducible to being 'for' or 'against'.

BOOK 14 OF 14

The Gospel of Matthew, the Gospel of Luke

Not as religious reading, but as one of the oldest sources of language about power, sacrifice and responsibility — something so deeply embedded in European thought that it has become invisible.

The list reflects how the club actually moves — from a shared vocabulary of relationships and power (Berne, Winnicott, Zoja) to questions about what stable structures even are — family, folktale, strategy, the firm (Ariès, Leshchenko, Propp, Lorenz, Luttwak, Coase) — and on to who the entrepreneur is and how the language we think in actually works (Shchedrovitsky, Piatigorsky, the Gospels).

The calendar — which book falls in which month — and the participation fee are being finalized separately; the opening meeting of “Level 3” is on September 12, 2026, at Dom Arkhitektora, Kaluga.

КАК ЗАПИСАТЬСЯ

Format and meeting frequency — to be confirmed

Sign up: aelita-production.ru/book-space · aelita.production@yandex.ru